

WEEK 2 OF 4 · Mind

Script 2: The 360-Degree Guard (Zanshin)**Theme: Peripheral Awareness**

Rationale: Zanshin is awareness of oneself within one's surroundings. This script teaches students to move from tunnel vision to total awareness — expanding attention so that you don't fixate on just one part and miss the whole.

Request that students find their meditation stance. Remind students of the "out."

"We are going to practice Zanshin — total awareness. When we spar, if we focus too hard on one thing, we lose track of everything else. We want a mind that sees everything at once.

Settle into your stance. I want you to pick a single spot on the floor or wall in front of you. Focus on it intently. This is 'Tunnel Vision.' Notice how the rest of the room fades away. (Pause for 20 seconds.)

Now, without moving your eyes, I want you to soften your gaze. Begin to notice what is to the left and right of that spot. Expand your awareness further. Can you see the walls on the side of the room? Can you sense the person sitting next to you without looking at them? (Pause for 20 seconds.)

Now, include your ears. Listen to the sounds in the room... the hum of the lights... the sound of your own breath... the sound of traffic outside. You are not looking at one thing; you are aware of everything.

This is the mind of the master — calm, wide, and alert. Hold this wide awareness for three deep breaths. (Pause for 20 seconds.) When you are ready, bring your attention back to the room."